

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction
for the administration of meningococcal group B vaccine (Bexsero and Trumenba)
for protection against invasive meningococcal group B disease

Guideline Summary: Green Book chapter 22 (Meningococcal)

The disease

- Invasive meningococcal disease is fatal in 5% to 10% of cases, and survivors may be left with hearing loss, severe visual impairment, limb amputation, seizures or brain damage.
- Incidence is highest in infants under one year, with a second peak in 15 to 19 year olds. Living in closed or semi-closed communities such as university halls raises the risk.
- Group B has become re-established across all age groups since 2021/22, while disease from the other groups remains very rare.

The two vaccines are not interchangeable in schedule

- Bexsero is the four-component protein vaccine (4CMenB), licensed from 2 months of age, and is the vaccine used in the routine infant programme.
- Trumenba is the bivalent fHbp vaccine (MenB-fHbp), authorised for individuals aged 10 years and over as a 2 or 3 dose schedule. It has no role below 10 years.
- They have different antigens, different licensed ages and different schedules. Choose the product first, then follow that product's schedule; do not mix schedules between them.
- Where a course has been started with one product, complete it with the same product wherever possible.

Where a pharmacy service fits

- The routine infant doses at 8 weeks, 12 weeks and 12 months are given by the NHS programme. Families should be directed there rather than paying privately.
- This PGD is for privately funded vaccination: infants and children whose routine doses were missed or who present outside the programme, adolescents and students seeking protection, and adults at increased risk.
- MenB vaccine is NOT recommended for travel. Travellers needing meningococcal protection require MenACWY; use the MenACWY PGD, including for Hajj and Umrah where a certificate is a visa requirement.
- Vaccines for private, occupational health or travel use are not supplied free of charge and must be ordered from the manufacturer.

Groups at increased risk

- Asplenia or splenic dysfunction, complement disorders, and treatment with a complement inhibitor such as eculizumab all raise the risk of invasive meningococcal disease substantially.
- Individuals due to start a complement inhibitor should be vaccinated at least 2 weeks before treatment begins, unless the risk of delaying treatment outweighs the risk of infection. Where treatment starts less than 2 weeks after vaccination, prophylactic antibiotics are required until 2 weeks after the vaccine.
- Laboratory staff handling *Neisseria meningitidis* require MenACWY (one dose) and 4CMenB (two doses), with boosters of both every 5 years.
- The need for, and timing of, booster doses of MenB vaccine in at-risk individuals has not yet been determined.

Patient Group Direction

for the administration of

Meningococcal group B vaccine: Bexsero (4CMenB) and Trumenba (MenB-fHbp)

for protection against invasive meningococcal group B disease

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC • Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. • All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines • All users must have completed immunisation training in line with the National Minimum Standards and Core Curriculum for Immunisation Training • All users must be competent in the recognition and management of anaphylaxis, and in vaccine handling and cold chain management • All users must previously have used PGD's to supply medication • Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer • All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal • All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products • All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005 • All users must be familiar with Gillick competence and the assessment of consent in children and young people, and with the involvement of a person with parental responsibility

Clinical condition or situation to which this PGD applies

PGD Indication	Active immunisation against invasive disease caused by <i>Neisseria meningitidis</i> group B, in accordance with Chapter 22 of Immunisation Against Infectious Disease (the Green Book) and the current SPC for the product used. Bexsero (4CMenB) may be given from 2 months of age; Trumenba (MenB-fHbp) from 10 years of age. This PGD covers privately funded vaccination and does not replace the NHS routine infant programme.
Inclusion criteria	• Aged 2 months and over for Bexsero, or 10 years and over for Trumenba. • Requires protection against meningococcal group B disease: routine doses missed or presenting outside the NHS programme, an adolescent or student seeking protection, or an adult at increased risk. • Valid informed consent obtained, from a person with parental responsibility where the individual is under 16 and not Gillick competent.

	• A person with parental responsibility, or a suitable adult authorised by them, is present for the vaccination of a child under 16 years. • No contraindication as set out below.
Exclusion criteria	• Aged under 2 months. • Aged under 10 years where Trumenba is the only product available. Trumenba has no licence below 10 years; use Bexsero or refer. • Confirmed anaphylactic reaction to a previous dose of the same vaccine. • Confirmed anaphylactic reaction to any component of the vaccine, or to any residue from the manufacturing process. • Acute severe febrile illness. Postpone until recovered. A minor illness without fever or systemic upset is not a reason to postpone. • Valid informed consent not obtained, or no person with parental responsibility available to consent for a child under 16 who is not Gillick competent. • A request for MenB vaccination for travel purposes. MenB is not recommended for travel; assess for MenACWY under the relevant PGD instead. • Management of a case, contact or outbreak of meningococcal disease. This is directed by the local Health Protection Team and is outside this PGD.
Cautions including any relevant action to be taken	• Facilities and trained staff for the management of anaphylaxis must be available, with immediate access to adrenaline (epinephrine) 1 in 1,000 injection and a telephone. • Prophylactic paracetamol is advised where Bexsero is given to infants under one year, because fever is common, particularly when given with other routine vaccines. Give 2.5 ml of infant paracetamol 120mg/5ml as soon as possible after vaccination, a second dose after 4 to 6 hours and a third 4 to 6 hours after that. Ibuprofen is less effective and is not recommended. • Advise the parent or carer to seek medical advice if the child is noticeably unwell with a fever, or if fever occurs at other times. • Asplenia, splenic dysfunction, complement disorders and complement inhibitor therapy: vaccinate, but see the timing requirements above regarding complement inhibitors and prophylactic antibiotics, and involve the specialist team. • Immunosuppression and HIV, regardless of CD4 count: vaccinate in accordance with the routine schedule, but the individual may not make a full antibody response. Re-immunisation may be considered after treatment finishes; specialist advice may be required. • Pregnancy and breastfeeding: meningococcal vaccines may be given when clinically indicated. There is no evidence of risk from vaccinating pregnant or breastfeeding women with inactivated vaccines. • A previous systemic or local reaction to a meningococcal vaccine, including fever of any severity, a hypotonic-hyporesponsive episode, persistent crying for more than 3 hours, a severe local reaction of any extent, or a convulsion within 3 days, does not prevent further doses. • Very premature infants born at or before 28 weeks who are in hospital should have respiratory monitoring for 48 to 72 hours

	after their first immunisation. Immunisation should not be withheld or delayed. Where given with other vaccines, use a separate site, preferably a different limb, or at least 2.5 cm apart in the same limb. Record the site of each.
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative options and how these can be accessed, including the NHS routine programme for infants, their GP practice, and the MenACWY PGD where the request is travel related. Explain the risks of meningococcal disease and the benefit of vaccination. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate. Where the individual is at increased risk through asplenia, a complement disorder or complement inhibitor therapy, make the referral clear and timely.

Vaccines and schedules covered by this PGD

Green Book schedule guidance supersedes the SPC. Confirm the current schedule and the licensed age before administration.

Vaccine	Age	Dose and route	Schedule
Bexsero (4CMenB, GSK). Contains NHBA, NadA and fHbp 50 micrograms each, plus 25 micrograms outer membrane vesicles	From 2 months	0.5 ml intramuscular. Anterolateral thigh in infants under 1 year, deltoid thereafter	Infants under 12 months outside the NHS programme: 2 doses at least 4 weeks apart, followed by a booster at 12 months. Children 12 months to under 2 years who had fewer than 2 doses in the first year: 2 further doses at least 4 weeks apart. Aged 2 years and over, including adolescents and adults: 2 doses at least 1 month apart.
Trumenba (MenB-fHbp, Pfizer). Contains recombinant fHbp subfamily A and subfamily B, 60 micrograms each, adsorbed on aluminium phosphate	From 10 years	0.5 ml intramuscular, deltoid	Routine use: 2 doses at 0 and 6 months. Individuals at increased risk, or in an outbreak setting where advised: 3 doses at 0, 1 to 2 months, and 6 months.

Details of the medicines

Legal category	POM
Off-label use	This PGD does not authorise off-label use. Administration must be within the licensed age and dose for the product supplied, following the Green Book schedule where it differs from the SPC.
Storage	Store at +2°C to +8°C. Do not freeze; discard if frozen. Store in the original packaging to protect from light. Vaccine exposed to conditions outside this range must be quarantined and risk assessed in accordance with UKHSA Vaccine Incident Guidance before any decision on continued use.
Route/method of administration	- Intramuscular injection. Use the anterolateral thigh for infants aged 1 year and under, and the deltoid for older children and adults. - Inspect visually before administration and do not use if the appearance differs from that described in the SPC. - May be given at the same time as any other vaccine required, at a separate site.
Dose and frequency of administration	As set out in the schedule table above, according to the product used and the age of the individual. One 0.5 ml dose per administration.
Quantity to be administered and/or	One 0.5 ml dose per administration. Book the next dose in the course at

supplied	the same appointment.
Maximum or minimum treatment period	The course for the product and age as set out above. The need for, and timing of, further booster doses in at-risk individuals has not yet been determined, other than the 5 yearly boosters for laboratory staff handling <i>Neisseria meningitidis</i> .
Disposal	Dispose of used syringes, needles and any discharged vaccine in a UN-approved puncture-resistant sharps container in accordance with local arrangements and HTM 07-01.
Drug interactions	May be given at the same time as other vaccines at a separate site. The immune response may be reduced in individuals who are immunosuppressed; this is not a reason to withhold vaccination.
Adverse effects	Bexsero in adolescents and adults: injection site pain, malaise and headache are most common. In infants and children up to 10 years: injection site reactions, fever of 38°C or above and irritability are very common, with diarrhoea, vomiting, feeding problems, sleepiness, unusual crying and rash also common. Fever peaks at around 6 hours and has usually gone by 48 hours. Trumenba in those aged 10 and over: headache, diarrhoea, nausea, muscle pain, joint pain, fatigue, chills, and injection site pain, swelling and redness. Refer to the current SPC for the full list.
Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse reactions to the MHRA via the Yellow Card scheme at https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk . All suspected reactions in children, and serious reactions in adults, should be reported. Document any adverse reaction in the individual's record and inform their GP.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: - that valid informed consent was given by the individual, or by a person with parental responsibility, or that a decision was made in the individual's best interests in accordance with the Mental Capacity Act 2005 - name of individual, address, date of birth and GP with whom the individual is registered - name of immuniser - name and brand of vaccine - date of administration - dose, form and route of administration - quantity administered - batch number and expiry date - anatomical site of vaccination - advice given, including advice given if the individual is excluded or declines immunisation - details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken - that the vaccine was administered via PGD - batch number, expiry date and anatomical site of administration - which product was given and which dose in the course it represents, so the course can be completed with the same product Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. The individual's GP should be informed. - Adults aged 18 years and over: keep records for 8 years - Children aged under 18 years: keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)

Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Offer the marketing authorisation holder's patient information leaflet for the product given, and a written record showing the product, the date, and when the next dose is due. For infants receiving Bexsero, give written paracetamol advice.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	Explain that the course must be completed for full protection and confirm when the next dose is due. Counsel on expected side effects and their management, and on Yellow Card reporting. Explain that the vaccine does not protect against all causes of meningitis and septicaemia, so the signs of meningococcal disease still matter: seek urgent medical help for a fever with a rash that does not fade under pressure, severe headache, neck stiffness, dislike of bright light, drowsiness or confusion. For infants given Bexsero, explain the expected fever and the paracetamol schedule.

Key references

- Immunisation Against Infectious Disease (the Green Book), Chapter 22 (Meningococcal), 10 June 2025 - Summary of Product Characteristics for Bexsero (GSK) and Trumenba (Pfizer), current versions - UKHSA: Meningococcal disease, guidance on public health management - NICE NG240: Meningitis (bacterial) and meningococcal disease - UKHSA Vaccine Incident Guidance - NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions
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Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates	

Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature

Valid from date	Expiry date
25/8/26	31/7/27

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or vaccine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

Name of superintendent /	Job title & name of	Signature	Date
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clinical lead	organisation		
Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		14/08/2026
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		14/08/2026

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development and issue of new PGD	30th July 2026

VACCINE SAFETY REQUIREMENT, ADDED AT VERSION 003, 9 SEPTEMBER 2026

This requirement forms part of this Patient Group Direction and must be met before any vaccine is administered under it. It was absent from the signed document and was added by this reissue after an estate-wide safety sweep of every vaccination PGD.

Observation after vaccination

- OBSERVE EVERY PATIENT FOR 15 MINUTES AFTER VACCINATION, SEATED.
- Anxiety-related reactions including vasovagal syncope, hyperventilation and transient visual disturbance or paraesthesia can occur before or after any injection, and are commonest in adolescents. They are a response to the needle, not to the vaccine.
- Have procedures in place to prevent injury from a faint.
- Record that the observation period was completed.

Version and change record

- Version: v003
- Issued: 9 September 2026
- Supersedes: Version 002, 14 August 2026
- Change: a 15 minute observation period after vaccination is now stated in this document. It was the last vaccination PGD in the estate without one. This addendum is appended to the signed version 002 rather than replacing it, because no editable source for version 002 exists; nothing in the version 002 text is altered.
- This reissue adds the requirement above and changes nothing else. It is NOT a clinical review of this PGD, and one remains outstanding.
- Authorised by Nitin Shori, Medical Director (GMC 6047293) and Chris Pilkington, Head Pharmacist (GPhC 2046322), on 9 September 2026. Signatures applied digitally on their joint instruction.